Tocod D. Macaraya Sr

Atty. Tocod D. Macaraya Sr. was a prominent Maranao lawyer, legal scholar, academic administrator, and statesman who left a lasting and definitive mark on the legal, political, and educational landscape of Mindanao. He was a **Delegate to the 1971 Constitutional Convention** representing Lanao del Sur.

He's recognized today as one of the premier legal minds from the region, a foundational pillar of the Mindanao State University (MSU) System, and the principal architect behind the early structures of regional autonomy for Muslim Mindanao.

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Legal Career and Bar Distinction

In 1954, Macaraya sat for the Philippine Bar Examination, a year that turned out to be one of the most storied in the history of the Philippine legal profession.

That batch produced Florenz Regalado, who achieved what remains the highest bar exam score ever recorded in the country: 96.7%.

Against that extraordinary field, Macaraya finished with a general average of **92.65%**, placing him among the **Top 15 topnotchers nationwide**.

For a young Maranao lawyer in post-war Philippines, that ranking wasn't just a personal achievement. It was a statement, clear proof that Muslim Mindanao had legal talent that belonged on the national stage, at a time when few from the region had found their way there.

University Administration and Reform

Macaraya gave a major portion of his career to the growth and stability of the Mindanao State University (MSU) System, a landmark institution founded in Marawi City to advance peace and socio-economic development in the south of the Philippines.

He served in two pivotal administrative capacities across different periods of the university's history.

Officer-in-Charge (1974–1975)

During a period of intense socio-political turbulence in the region, Macaraya stepped in as the interim head of the university.

His main task was keeping MSU functional and its academic mission on track while the broader Mindanao landscape was in upheaval.

It wasn't a glamorous role, but it was a necessary one, and Macaraya handled it with the steady hand the institution needed.

First Executive Vice President (1989–1990)

A decade and a half later, Macaraya came back to MSU in a much more formal and historic capacity.

Under Special Order No. 03-P issued in 1989, he was designated as the university system's very first Executive Vice President, making him the inaugural holder of that office in MSU System history.

In that capacity, he formalized structural expansions across the growing system and introduced administrative reforms that laid operational groundwork still felt in the MSU of today.

Regional Autonomy and Statecraft

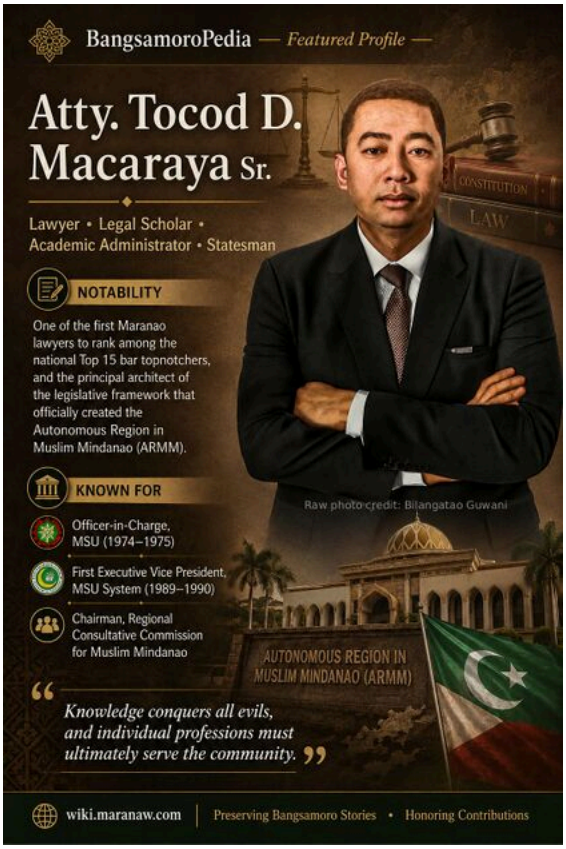
If there's one chapter of Macaraya's career that eclipses the others in terms of national impact, it's his chairmanship of the Regional Consultative Commission (RCC) for Muslim Mindanao.

Following the ratification of the 1987 Philippine Constitution, he was appointed to lead this body, which carried a mandate of real historical weight: conduct genuine grassroots consultations across Muslim Mindanao and produce a legal framework for regional self-governance.

The RCC's Consultations

Operating out of Zamboanga City through 1988, the commission went on the ground. They conducted extensive multi-sectoral consultations across communities throughout Mindanao, making sure ordinary Moros had a voice in shaping the structure of their own political future.

Atty. Tocod D. Macaraya Sr.



Ethnicity
Maranao
Nationality
Filipino
Professions
Lawyer · Legal Scholar · Academic Administrator · Statesman
Institution
Mindanao State University System
Bar Examination
1954 Philippine Bar · 92.65% General Average · Top 15 Nationwide
Key Positions Held
Delegate to the 1971 Constitutional Convention; Officer-in-Charge, MSU (1974–1975) · First Executive Vice President, MSU System (1989–1990) · Chairman, Regional Consultative Commission for Muslim Mindanao

This wasn't a top-down exercise in paper drafting. It was deliberate, community-by-community listening, structured to give the eventual legislation real democratic roots.

Drafting the Organic Act for ARMM

Under Macaraya's chairmanship, the RCC consolidated those consultations into a legislative draft that would serve as the foundation for one of the most consequential pieces of legislation in post-Marcos Philippine history.

That draft became the primary basis for what Congress enacted as **Republic Act No. 6734**, the Organic Act that officially created the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM).

Without the foundational work of the RCC under his leadership, the path toward Moro political self-determination would've looked considerably different.

Major Legislation
Republic Act No. 6734 (Organic Act for the ARMM)
Notability
One of the first Maranao lawyers to rank among the national Top 15 bar topnotchers, and the principal architect of the legislative framework that officially created the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM).
Known For
1954 Bar Top 15 Topnotcher · Pioneering MSU Executive Vice President · Chairman of the Regional Consultative Commission · Co-drafter of Republic Act No. 6734
Pull Quote
"Knowledge conquers all evils, and individual professions must ultimately serve the community."

Literary and Scholarly Contributions

Outside the halls of government and the boardrooms of the university, Macaraya was also a writer and a thoughtful documentarian of Maranao and Islamic intellectual tradition in the Philippines.

His most noted scholarly work is a 1988 publication titled *Nomination Letter for the 1988 King Faisal International Award for Service of Islām and other Related Papers*.

The text centers on statesman Ahmad Domocao Alonto and draws out the intersections between Islamic identity, governance, and the long peace struggle in Mindanao, illuminating how faith and politics were never entirely separate in the Bangsamoro experience.

It remains a key secondary source for historians studying the socio-political dimensions of Muslim Filipino leadership.

Legacy

Atty. Tocod D. Macaraya Sr. is remembered as a bridge-builder, a Maranao son who worked the difficult ground between minority aspirations and national legal structures, and who did it with intellectual rigor, institutional patience, and a genuine sense of purpose.

His philosophy, recorded in the annals of the MSU, puts it plainly: *knowledge conquers all evils*, and one's profession must ultimately serve the community, not just the individual.<ref name="msuPresidents"/>

That guiding belief shows up clearly in everything he built. He used law to assert worth, academia to prepare a generation, and statecraft to open constitutional doors for a region that had long been waiting for them.

His central role in drafting the Organic Act for the ARMM places him among a very small number of Maranao statesmen who directly shaped the constitutional future of their people, not through words alone, but through the legal architecture they left standing.<ref name="senate6734"/><ref name="stanford"/>

References

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- **Research output file** (https://tinyurl.com/2dhn8hy2)

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Republic Act No. 6734
- Ahmad Domocao Alonto
- Maranao people
- Philippine Bar Examination
- Regional Consultative Commission

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